

Balancing creativity and control

Another widespread myth is that innovation is solely about creativity—that all that is needed is an environment in which bright ideas can be explored. This is not true: it does not matter how many interesting ideas are flying around the place if nothing useful comes of them. Managing innovation is not only about unleashing creativity, but also about harnessing and focusing it. It is a balancing act—on the one hand releasing the flow of ideas to create and sharpen up innovations, and on the other making sure the ideas are focused toward actually delivering results that benefits the organization, without taking forever or consuming a vast budget. Managing innovation means balancing creativity with direction and control.

TIP

GET IDEAS REVIEWED

Make sure all suggestions are reviewed by more than one person, in case the initial reviewer misses any hidden potential.

HARNESSING CREATIVITY



FAST TRACK



OFF TRACK

Supporting creativity across the organization

Failing to implement good ideas

Investing in research and development

Creating new technologies without first ensuring they will be beneficial

Listening to customers to find out what innovations they want

Missing out on breakthrough innovations not yet conceived

Building a strong internal innovation infrastructure

Neglecting ideas from outside the organization

Using technology to solve product, process, and service problems

Focusing on technology and missing out on innovations